GLOUCESTER
ZAKAT FUND
CHARITY FOR LOCAL RESIDENTS

COUNTER EXTREMISM POLICY

Document Information	
Policy Name	Counter Extremism Policy
Version	1.0
Policy Owner	Board of Trustees
Approved by	Board of Trustees
Date Approved	01/02/2026
Next Review Date	01/02/2028
Related Policies	Safeguarding Policy, Anti-Money Laundering Policy, Anti-Terrorism Policy, Due Diligence Policy, Social Media Policy

1. Introduction and Purpose

1.1 Introduction

Gloucester Zakat Charity ("the Charity") is a Charitable Incorporated Organisation registered in England, established to prevent and relieve poverty and financial hardship in Gloucestershire and the wider United Kingdom, with a particular focus on members of the Muslim community.

As a charity entrusted with public donations, including Zakat (obligatory Islamic almsgiving) and Sadaqah (voluntary charity), we have a duty to ensure that our charity is not used to promote hatred, violence, or extremism of any kind. The trustees have a responsibility to protect the Charity from being used for purposes incompatible with its charitable objects.

The good works of the Charity could be seriously undermined if a speaker at an event, a volunteer on social media, or a partner organisation were associated with extremist views or activities. This policy sets out our commitment to preventing such abuse and protecting the Charity's reputation and integrity.

1.2 Purpose

The purpose of this Counter Extremism Policy is to:

- Ensure the Charity is not used for purposes incompatible with its charitable objects
- Prevent the Charity's funds, services, name, or reputation being used to promote terrorism, intolerance, hatred, or violence
- Protect the Charity's reputation and maintain public trust
- Protect freedom of speech in accordance with the law
- Foster and promote good community relations
- Provide a framework for determining the suitability of speakers, partners, and volunteers
- Comply with Charity Commission guidance on protecting charities from abuse for extremist purposes
- Ensure appropriate due diligence is conducted on speakers and partner organisations

1.3 Our Values

The Charity considers the fulfilment of its constitutional objects a trust (amanah). We believe it is a moral and religious obligation to work sincerely towards providing assistance to those in need and using Zakat and Sadaqah funds for their correct purposes. We believe that speakers, partners, and volunteers represent the Charity and must uphold standards consistent with our values of compassion, integrity, and service to the community.

2. Scope

2.1 Who This Policy Applies To

This policy applies to:

- All trustees of the Charity
- All volunteers working on behalf of the Charity
- Speakers invited to speak at Charity events or workshops
- Partner organisations working with the Charity (such as GARAS, GMWA, GIT, and GBA)
- Anyone representing or acting on behalf of the Charity
- Content published on the Charity's website, social media, or communications

2.2 Activities Covered

This policy covers:

- Zakat education workshops and community awareness sessions
- Fundraising events at mosques and community venues
- Community outreach activities
- Partnerships and collaborations with other organisations
- Social media activity conducted in the Charity's name
- Any public-facing activity or communication

3. Legal Framework

3.1 Charity Law

Trustees have legal duties under the Charities Act 2011 to act reasonably and prudently in all matters relating to the Charity, to act in the Charity's best interests, and to safeguard and protect the Charity's assets, including its reputation.

The Charity Commission's Compliance Toolkit states: "All charities must comply with UK law and so must not promote or support terrorism or extremism, or other illegal conduct, such as racial or religious hatred. Nor can a charity's name, premises or money be used to promote extremist and other activities which are inappropriate under charity law."

Trustees must not allow the Charity to be used as a vehicle for the expression of personal or party-political views of any individual trustee or volunteer.

3.2 Human Rights

Article 19 of The Universal Declaration of Human Rights states: "Everyone has the right to freedom of opinion and expression; this right includes freedom to hold opinions without interference and to seek, receive and impart information and ideas through any media and regardless of frontiers."

The Human Rights Act 1998 provides protection for freedom of thought, conscience, expression, and association, and protection from discrimination. However, freedom of speech is not absolute and may be restricted where necessary to prevent criminal offences, incitement to commit criminal acts, or discrimination against protected groups.

3.3 Terrorism Legislation

The Terrorism Act 2000 makes it a criminal offence to incite or encourage others to commit acts of terrorism or to glorify terrorism, whether directly or indirectly. It is sufficient if the speaker is reckless as to whether members of the public may be encouraged to commit, prepare, or instigate acts of terrorism.

Charities cannot provide a platform for, or condone or support, terrorist activities or ideologies. Trustees must be vigilant to ensure that the Charity's premises, assets, volunteers, and other resources cannot be used for activities that may, or may appear to, support or condone terrorist activities.

Even indirect or informal links with a proscribed terrorist organisation pose unacceptable risks. Examples include allowing charity events, websites, or literature to be used to support a proscribed organisation, or associating with someone who is a known supporter of such an organisation.

3.4 Racial and Religious Hatred

The Racial and Religious Hatred Act 2006 makes it an offence to stir up hatred on the grounds of religion or race. The incitement of hatred or violence by a speaker based on religious or racial grounds is unacceptable and will not be tolerated.

4. Policy Statement

Gloucester Zakat Charity is committed to:

- Ensuring that our charity, its name, funds, and reputation are not used to promote terrorism, extremism, intolerance, hatred, or violence
- Conducting appropriate due diligence on speakers, partners, and volunteers
- Protecting freedom of speech within the limits of the law
- Fostering good relations within and between communities
- Not promoting sectarianism or hostility to other religious communities
- Not allowing the Charity to be used to promote any political party or candidate
- Taking appropriate action where speakers, partners, or volunteers breach this policy
- Reporting concerns to the appropriate authorities, including the Charity Commission and police where necessary

5. Roles and Responsibilities

5.1 Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees is collectively responsible for:

- Approving and reviewing this policy
- Ensuring this policy is communicated to all relevant parties
- Making final decisions on whether to approve or refuse speakers and partners
- Monitoring compliance with this policy
- Reporting serious incidents to the Charity Commission
- Designating a trustee to oversee speaker/partner vetting

5.2 Designated Trustee

The Chair of Trustees (or a trustee delegated by the Board) will act as the designated person responsible for overseeing speaker and partner vetting. This person is responsible for undertaking or overseeing due diligence checks, making recommendations to the Board, maintaining records of checks undertaken, and providing induction to new trustees and volunteers on this policy.

5.3 All Trustees and Volunteers

All trustees and volunteers must:

- Be familiar with this policy and comply with its requirements
- Report any concerns about potential extremism, hatred, or inappropriate content
- Ensure that any speakers they propose have been appropriately vetted
- Not make statements or post content on social media that could bring the Charity into disrepute
- Uphold the values of the Charity in all their activities

6. Due Diligence Procedures

6.1 Speakers

Before any speaker is confirmed for a Charity event or workshop, appropriate due diligence must be conducted. The level of due diligence should be proportionate to the nature of the event and the profile of the speaker.

Due diligence checks should include (as appropriate):

- Internet search (Google, Bing) on the speaker's name
- Review of publicly available social media profiles
- YouTube or video search for previous talks or sermons
- Check against Home Office proscribed organisations list
- Check against HM Treasury financial sanctions list
- References from other reputable charities or organisations that have used the speaker
- Review of news articles or media coverage
- For speakers representing organisations: Charity Commission search

All findings should be documented and retained. Where sources of questionable credibility discredit a speaker, further checks should be conducted to establish the credibility of those sources.

6.2 Partner Organisations

Before entering into formal partnerships or collaborations with organisations such as GARAS, GMWA, GIT, GBA, or others, the Charity will conduct proportionate due diligence. This includes verifying the organisation's charitable status (if applicable), reviewing its public reputation, checking for any adverse information, and ensuring the organisation's values are compatible with those of the Charity.

6.3 Volunteers

Volunteers who will be representing the Charity in public-facing roles, handling social media, or speaking on behalf of the Charity should be made aware of this policy and the standards expected. The spirit of this policy applies to volunteer conduct on social media and in public.

7. Decision-Making Process

Once due diligence has been completed on a proposed speaker or partner, the information gathered will be assessed in light of this policy and the legal framework set out in Section 3.

Based on the information, the Charity may decide to:

1. Allow the speaker or partnership to proceed unchanged
2. Require changes to the subject matter, format, or publicity materials
3. Request a copy of the speech or presentation in advance
4. Refuse the speaker or partnership

All decisions and the reasons for them should be documented. Where a speaker or partnership is refused, the person or organisation may be informed of the decision (without necessarily disclosing all reasons if this would compromise other interests).

8. Refusal or Termination

The Charity reserves the right to refuse or terminate any speaker, event, or partnership where it deems it is in the Charity's interests to do so.

Circumstances in which this might happen include:

- A speaker publicising an event before receiving formal Charity approval
- Changes to event content, speakers, or materials which may have prevented approval
- Comments made on social media that breach this policy or the Charity's values
- New information coming to light about the speaker or partner which, had it been known earlier, may have led to refusal
- Advice from the Police, Charity Commission, or other authorities that the event should not proceed or the speaker should not be allowed
- A threat to public order or the safety of attendees

Where advice is received from authorities, the Charity will carefully consider whether the concern is a genuine threat that laws will be broken or hatred spread, or whether it represents an unjustified restriction on freedom of speech.

9. Political and Religious Matters

9.1 Political Activity

The Charity does not allow the promotion of any political party or candidate, nor does it allow its events or platforms to be used to canvass support for political purposes.

However, the Charity may permit:

- A serving MP, councillor, or public official to participate in an event as part of their normal duties to help raise the profile of the Charity's work

The Charity would not permit:

- An individual candidate using any Charity event to solicit support for themselves or their party

9.2 Religious Matters

The Charity is a Muslim faith-based organisation, but in its charitable work does not discriminate based on religion. The Charity will not promote sectarianism or hostility to other religious communities or sects within Islam. Reference to other faiths or groups within a positive framework of discussion is acceptable.

10. Social Media

The values and spirit of this policy apply to all social media activity conducted in the Charity's name or on behalf of the Charity. All trustees and volunteers with access to Charity social media accounts must:

- Not post content that promotes extremism, hatred, violence, or intolerance
- Not share or amplify content from individuals or organisations with extremist links
- Consider how content may be perceived before posting
- Remove inappropriate content promptly if posted in error
- Report any concerns about content to the Board of Trustees

Personal social media activity by trustees and volunteers should also be conducted in a manner that does not bring the Charity into disrepute. See also the Social Media Policy.

11. Training and Awareness

To ensure effective implementation of this policy:

- All new trustees will receive a copy of this policy as part of their induction and will be briefed on its contents
- Volunteers in public-facing roles will be made aware of this policy and the standards expected
- Partner organisations will be informed of this policy and expected to comply with its principles
- Prospective speakers will be made aware of the guidelines and expectations before agreeing to speak
- This policy will be reviewed annually at a Board meeting

12. Record Keeping

The Charity will maintain records of due diligence checks undertaken on speakers and partners, including copies or screenshots of relevant searches and the conclusions reached. These records will be retained for six years.

Records of any decisions to refuse or terminate speakers or partnerships, including the reasons for the decision, will also be retained.

13. Review

This policy will be reviewed by the Board of Trustees every two years, or sooner if:

- There are significant changes to charity law or Charity Commission guidance
- A serious incident occurs that highlights gaps in the policy
- The Charity's activities or risk profile change significantly
- The Board identifies a need for updates

14. Related Policies and Documents

This policy should be read in conjunction with:

- Safeguarding Policy
- Anti-Money Laundering Policy
- Anti-Terrorism / Counter-Terrorism Policy
- Due Diligence Policy
- Social Media Policy
- Volunteer Management Policy
- Trustee Code of Conduct

Regulatory Guidance:

- Charity Commission – Compliance Toolkit: Protecting Charities from Harm, Chapter 5: Protecting Charities from Abuse for Extremist Purposes
- Charity Commission – Reporting Serious Incidents
- Home Office – Proscribed Terrorist Organisations
- HM Treasury – Financial Sanctions Consolidated List

15. Approval and Version History

Version	Date	Approved By	Changes
1.0	01/02/2026	Board of Trustees	Initial policy

16. Trustee Declaration

We, the undersigned trustees of Gloucester Zakat Charity, confirm that we have read, understood, and approved this Counter Extremism Policy and commit to its implementation.

Name	Role	Signature	Date
Mr Abdullah Abdul Samad Patel	Chair	A. Patel	01/02/2026
Mr Kamel Boulkenafet	Trustee	K. Boulkenafet	01/02/2026
Mr Hashim Moolla	Trustee	H. Moolla	01/02/2026
Mr Farouq Ginwalla	Trustee	F. Ginwalla	01/02/2026
Ms Mariam Qureshi	Trustee	M. Qureshi	01/02/2026

Appendix 1: Speaker Due Diligence Checklist

The following checks should be undertaken on proposed speakers. Note all findings and conclusions and keep copies or screenshots of relevant sources as evidence.

1. YouTube search for previous talks, sermons, or presentations – sample topics and content
2. Google search on the name (general web search, image search, and news search)
3. Bing search (Google can be limited by 'right to be forgotten' requests)
4. Wikipedia search (if applicable)
5. Social media searches (LinkedIn, X/Twitter, Facebook) where publicly available
6. Home Office proscribed organisations list
7. HM Treasury financial sanctions consolidated list
8. Charity Commission register (for speakers representing charities)
9. References from other reputable charities or organisations that have used the speaker

If an organisation of questionable credibility discredits a potential speaker, conduct further checks on that organisation to establish whether its information should be relied upon. Context of speeches may also be considered, including whether clarifications have been made for any controversial statements.

Appendix 2: Speaker Agreement Form

STRICTLY PRIVATE & CONFIDENTIAL

Thank you for agreeing to speak at a Gloucester Zakat Charity event. The Charity has a Counter Extremism Policy which must be adhered to. By speaking at our event, you agree to the following guidelines:

1. All speakers must ensure they do not promote, advocate, or endorse hatred or violence against any person, group, or community.
2. Speakers must not promote, endorse, glorify, or praise terrorism in any form.
3. The presentation must be appropriate to the age and understanding of the audience.
4. Speakers must adopt appropriate language and behaviour at all times.
5. The content must contribute to the Charity's aims of poverty relief and Zakat education.
6. Speakers must not insult other faiths or groups. Reference to other faiths or groups within a positive framework of discussion is acceptable.
7. Speakers must not promote any political party or candidate.
8. Speakers are not permitted to raise or gather funds for any external organisation or cause without express written permission from the Board of Trustees.
9. Trustees and volunteers have the right and responsibility to interrupt or stop any talk or presentation that violates these guidelines.

I have read, understood, and agree to abide by the above guidelines.

Speaker Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

--- End of Policy ---